

Using common unix tools on text data

You must get comfortable with:

- process substitution
 - redirects
 - wc, grep, paste, cut, head, tail, etc...
-

Here's a zipped [directory](#). It contains 4 files: A.txt, B.txt, story.txt, and words.txt

Download and unzip it into a reasonable directory and use the files inside of it to accomplish the following tasks:

Task 1. Combine the contents of A.txt and B.txt into a new tab-separated file called C.txt (contents of C.txt shown below)

```
1      A
2      B
3      C
4      D
5      E
6      F
7      G
8      H
9      I
10     J
```

Task 2. Combine the words that begin with either B or E (case insensitive) from words.txt with the first 6 lines of the new C.txt file you just created.

```
1  A   Eat
2  B   Earth
3  C   Eggplant
4  D   bonanza
5  E   balloon
6  F   Billow
```

Task 3. Return the first 6 sentences from story.txt

Then all at once the wind stopped its howling. The pace began to slow down. Sophie could feel the Giant's feet pounding once again over the

earth. She poked her head up out of the blanket to have a look. They were in a country of thick forests and rushing rivers. The Giant had definitely slowed down and was now running more normally, although normal was a silly word to use to describe a galloping giant

Task 4. Return the first 6 sentences from story.txt, one per line and combine that with the first 6 lines of A.txt

(This requires a tricky command substitution)

```
1    Then all at once the wind stopped its howling
2    The pace began to slow down
3    Sophie could feel the Giant's feet pounding once again over the
earth
4    She poked her head up out of the blanket to have a look
5    They were in a country of thick forests and rushing rivers
6    The Giant had definitely slowed down and was now running more
normally, although normal was a silly word to use to describe a
galloping giant
```

Task 5. See if you understand the following:

- Can you understand what the following code does and why it works (or doesn't)?

```
echo "There are $(ls -1 *.txt | wc -l) files in this
directory."
```

- And this?

```
ls -1 | head -2 > first_2_files.txt && cat first_2_files.txt &&
rm first_2_files.txt
```

- And, finally, this?

```
cat file_that_does_not_exist.txt 2> err.txt | wc -l && cat
err.txt
```